Cucina povera: zero waste

Niente si butta

"Poor kitchen": how Italian home cooks turn leftovers into new meals, and save energy too.

1 Stale bread

Panzanella salad, ribollita and pappa al pomodoro soups, or breadcrumbs.

2 Leftover risotto

Shape into balls with a cube of cheese inside and fry: arancini.

3 Leftover pasta

Mix with beaten egg and cheese and fry: frittata di pasta.

4 Parmigiano rinds

Simmer in minestrone or bean soup for a deep flavour.

5 Vegetable peelings

Simmer with herb stalks for a free vegetable stock.

6 Overripe tomatoes

Cook down into passata and freeze for winter.

7 Soft fruit

Bake into a crostata or a simple fruit cake.

8 Cooked beans

Mash with garlic and oil on toast, or add to pasta e fagioli.

9 Herb stalks

Chop into soffritto, sauces and stocks.

10 Food scraps

Use the food-waste bin: scraps can become biogas and compost.